

Request for Proposal: AI Strategy Consultancy for ATDW AI Hub Initiative

The Australian Tourism Data Warehouse (ATDW) is Australia's only government-owned, centralized collection of over 60,000 tourism experience profiles. This dataset powers the digital channels of major Destination Marketing Organisations (DMOs), including Tourism Australia, Destination NSW, Tourism and Events Queensland, Visit Victoria, and others. This positions ATDW as a unique leader in the tourism sector, poised to leverage AI to deliver personalized, predictive, and contextual experiences across distributor platforms. Australia is one of the few countries globally with such a comprehensive tourism database, presenting a significant opportunity for AI transformation.

Our AI Hub initiative aims to build on this foundation to transform how travellers interact with Australian tourism businesses, enhancing personalized content and storytelling across both B2B (distributors) and B2C (travellers) platforms. We seek consultancy services to validate our vision and propose strategies to develop an AI-driven platform that future-proofs Australian tourism.

Key Areas for Consultancy Support

1. AI Infrastructure & Modularity
 - Assess the infrastructure required to deliver real-time, AI-powered content personalization and predictive analytics. We envision a modular system that allows distributors to opt in for additional features, such as booking functionality or smart recommendations, tailored to their specific needs. Importantly, distributors must have the ability to customize content delivery to suit their platform's unique tone, style, and target audience, ensuring a consistent yet personalized user experience.
2. Comprehensive User Journey
 - Explore how AI can support the entire traveller lifecycle—from dreaming and planning, through to booking and the in-destination experience. Proposals should include strategies for AI to improve user engagement, smart recommendations that increase the length of stay, and yield optimization in destinations. Additionally, include approaches to leveraging predictive analytics to anticipate traveller preferences and how AI can help ATDW become a key source for identifying content that resonates with specific demographics or regions.
3. AI Partnership Opportunities
 - Identify potential AI partnership opportunities that may be well-suited for ATDW. This could include technology providers or collaborations that enhance the AI Hub's capabilities, especially those that allow seamless integration with major platforms like Google Search and Google Maps, ensuring that AI-driven search and location data provide enriched traveller experiences.

4. Business Data & Analytics

- Propose strategies for utilizing AI to drive business data and analytics for both ATDW and its distributors. This should include identifying insights from user-generated content and platform interactions that help distributors optimize marketing strategies, improve conversion rates, and make data-driven decisions. AI-powered analytics should also assist in understanding traveller behavior, identifying trends, and improving business outcomes for tourism operators.

5. API & Integration for Distributors

- Recommend scalable, API-driven frameworks that enable seamless integration with distributors, allowing personalized content delivery that maintains each distributor's branding while providing users with a unified yet tailored experience. Additionally, explore how AI could help better integrate ATDW's data with Google platforms and other search engines to maximize visibility and impact.

6. Content Creation & Optimization

- Propose AI-driven tools for content creation that improve content completion rates and optimize conversion rates (CRO). These tools could include prompts or automated systems that assist tourism operators in providing high-quality, fully completed profiles, ultimately leading to better engagement and visibility across the network. Consider how ATDW could deploy virtual concierges or "pimped chatbots" to provide tailored support to users.

7. Build vs. Partner Assessment

- Provide a detailed assessment of whether ATDW should build its AI infrastructure from scratch or partner with existing technology providers. Consider long-term benefits, scalability, and integration options for both approaches. Additionally, we are keen to explore how AI search and recommendation engines could help ATDW provide more value, particularly in automating smart recommendations that enhance user engagement and drive business outcomes.

Next Steps

Consultancies are invited to express their interest in partnering with ATDW on this ambitious AI initiative. Interested consultancies should submit an expression of interest by **Monday, October 7, 2024**, indicating their intent to provide a full proposal. Full proposals should include:

- Your approach to validating the end-to-end traveller journey using AI and modular design considerations for distributors.
- Experience with scalable AI systems that handle large-scale user-generated content and predictive analytics.
- Estimated timeline and cost for conducting a comprehensive feasibility study.
- Potential risks and mitigation strategies, with a focus on data security and privacy.
- Key personnel and their relevant expertise in AI, data integration, and tourism technology.

Submission Deadline

